

Search Journey Report — What a Consumer Sees

Date: 2 July 2026. Detail: `agent_reports/agent1a_search_engines.md` (SE-, incl. full 26-query rank table), `agent_reports/agent9_ai_answers_maps.md` (AI-), `agent_reports/agent1b_number_searches.md` (NUM-).

Method: every query run on DuckDuckGo UK (`duckduckgo.com/html`) and Bing UK, with full-page screenshots and HTML archives (`screenshots/2026-07-02_ddg_<query-slug>_serp.png` , `..._bing_...` , matching `.html` in `source_archive/`). Google Search was reCAPTCHA-blocked on every attempt (block page preserved); Google *Maps* was accessible. AI-answer surfaces (Google AI Overviews, Bing Copilot tab) could not be rendered headlessly — machine conflation was instead demonstrated via captured AI search summaries (SE-07, AI-15, DIR-12) and Bing's inline AI answer box (AI-03).

The six journeys from the brief

1. "prima insurance"

Hello Prima ranks #1, the broker #3 on both engines. Both firms present as "Prima" / "Prima Insurance" with visually indistinguishable titles. The broker's snippet exposes its phone/email on DDG. **Ambiguous from the first query.**

2. "prima car insurance contact"

Broker #1 on Bing, #2 on DDG (insurer #1) — for an unambiguously *car-insurance* query. The broker's number is visible in the DDG snippet. A consumer clicking the top Bing result lands on the broker's contact page (0330 088 1135, `info@primainsurance.co.uk`).

3. "prima insurance claims"

Insurer #1; broker #5; third-party claims pages (`claimsnumber.com` — a claims-management company's own 0333 number; `prima.theclaimscentre.net` — Bolton 01204 numbers) rank prominently (SE-09–SE-11). Bing's AI answer box for "prima insurance claims number" gives Hello Prima's correct number but cites the **broker's contact page** as one of its two sources (AI-03).

4. "prima insurance complaints"

The broker's terms page snippet displays: "...Prima Financial Services Ltd, Complaints Department, 21 Bury New Road, Prestwich, M25 9JY or by phone on **0161 826 1620**" — the only complaints number visible on the SERP (SE-04, AI-06). Bing People-also-ask: "How do I register a complaint with Prima Financial Services Ltd?"

5. "prima insurance phone number"

The broker's contact page is the #1 result on BOTH engines, with 0330 088 1135 (and email) rendered in the snippet — no click needed (SE-01/SE-02, AI-01). On Bing it sits directly beneath a map/entity card for Hello Prima's London office labelled "Prima Insurance". Hello Prima's results show no number ("Missing: phone number").

6. "hello prima contact number"

Even fully branded: insurer #1, but the broker ranks #2 with its "Contact | Prima" title; on related branded queries ("helloprima phone number", "hello prima phone number") the broker's snippet shows 0330 088 1135 and Bing renders the broker's full entity card (number + Prestwich address). Bing's related-search chips include "prima insurance brokers" and "prima manchester phone number"; a People-also-ask entry is "How do I contact Prima House?" — the broker's building (SE-03, AI-04).

Quantified picture (26 queries tested)

- Both firms co-appear in the top ~10 for **24/26** queries.
- The broker's live phone number/email is rendered in a DDG snippet for **21/26** queries.
- For contact/phone/cancellation/wrong-number-intent queries the broker ranks #1–4.
- Cancellation queries additionally expose a third broker number (0330 118 0404, Cancellations Department) at rank #1–2 (SE-05). Full rank table: `agent_reports/agent1a_search_engines.md`.

Maps and AI layers

- **Google Maps "prima insurance"**: two listings, both named "Prima Insurance". The broker's shows +44 330 088 1135; Hello Prima's shows no number and an open "Add place's phone number" prompt (REV-01/02, AI-07–09). Manchester-viewpoint searches resolve to the broker.
- **AI summaries**: attributed the broker's number+address to helloprima.co.uk (SE-07); asserted the 0330 number "is indeed associated with Hello Prima's car insurance" (DIR-12); controlled test output "Main Customer Service Number: 0330 088 1135 ... official Prima car insurance contact numbers" (AI-15).
- **Noise**: a third "Prima" (Prima Group, Liverpool housing association, 0333 355 9000) ranks in every contact-intent SERP and was offered by AI summaries for Prima complaints (SE-11 context, AI-13).

Why the journey ends at the broker

Hello Prima publishes no phone number a searcher can find (removed from its help article in 2024; no /contact page has ever existed on its main site — WB-05/06), its own page titles say "Prima Insurance" (WB-04), aggregators hand customers the bare name "Prima" (AGG-01–04), and the open web's top-ranked, snippet-visible answer to "who do I ring about my Prima policy" is — on every engine tested — Prima Insurance Brokers' 0330 088 1135, with 0161 826 1620 surfacing specifically for complaints.

Conclusion: the captured search journeys make it *plausible to likely* that a Hello Prima customer seeking phone contact ends up calling Prima Insurance Brokers. The pack proves the journey, not the completed calls; call-log evidence from the broker would close that gap.